

YU-TING HUANG

PhD Candidate
Department of Economics
Georgia State University

Latest Update: September, 2026
Email: yhuang63@gsu.edu
Website: reinayutinghuang.com

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, Georgia State University (2022–*Expected May 2027*)
Advisor: Lauren Hoehn-Velasco
Committee members: James Marton, Elaine Meichen Liu, Melanie Guldi (University of Central Florida)
M.A. Economics, The University of Texas at Austin (2020-2022)
B.A. Economics, National Central University, Taiwan (2016-2020)
Study Abroad Program, University of Groningen, Netherlands (2019-2020)
Summer Exchange, Linköping University, Sweden (2018)
Summer Exchange, Shanghai Jiao Tong University, China (2017)

RESEARCH INTEREST

Health Economics, Public Economics, Labor Economics, Economics of Education, Digital Economics

PUBLICATIONS

The Long Shadow of Typhoons: Prenatal Exposure and Adult Mental Health
(with Elaine Meichen Liu, Jin-Tan Liu, and Tzu-Yin Hazel Tseng)
**Accepted, Journal of Development Economics*
Public Payment Mandates and Provider Supply: Evidence from Certified Nurse-Midwives
(with Lauren Hoehn-Velasco and Olanrewaju Yusuff)
**Accepted, American Journal of Health Economics*

WORKING PAPERS

Bytes and Births: The effect of Broadband Internet on Infant Health **JMP*
Full Day Kindergarten Mandates and Child Maltreatment (with Bogyung Kim)

WORKING IN PROGRESS

Universal Pre-Kindergarten, Childlessness, and Fertility (with Bogyung Kim)

EMPLOYMENT

Georgia State University

Research Assistant for Prof. Lauren Hoehn-Velasco (2023–Present)
Research Assistant for Prof. Michael Pesko regarding Tobacco Regulatory Science (2022-2023)

London Business School

Research Assistant for Prof. Bukky Akintanmi Oyedele (2022-2024)

The University of Texas at Austin

Research Assistant for Prof. Olivier Coibion and Prof. Nitya Pandalai-Nayar (2020-2022)

Institute for Information Industry, Taiwan

Assistant researcher, Robotics and Digital Healthcare, Market Intelligence & Consulting Institute (2020-2021)

TEACHING

Georgia State University

Instructor of Record, Global Economy, Undergraduate (2025 Spring)

Class size: 88 (In-person), Overall evaluation: 4.5/5

National Central University, Taiwan

Teaching Assistant, Microeconomics, Undergraduate (2019)

Teaching Assistant, NCU Learning By Doing Student Team Head (2017-2019)

CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS (*Scheduled)

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| 2027 | American Economic Association Annual Meeting, Washington, D.C. (Presenter)* |
| 2026 | Southern Economic Association, Houston, TX (Organized Session, Presenter)* |
| | 4th AEA CSQIEP Mentoring Conference, Chicago, IL (Presenter) |
| | Economics of Mental Health Workshop, Paris, France (Presenter) |
| | American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon), Minneapolis, MN (Presenter/Poster) |
| | Association for Education Finance & Policy (AEFP), Chicago, IL (Presenter) |
| | Public Policy and Child Well-being (PPCW), Atlanta, GA (Presenter) |
| | GSU Graduate Research Conference, Atlanta, GA (Presenter) |
| 2025 | Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM), Seattle, WA (Presenter) |
| | American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon), Nashville, TN (Presenter) |

HONORS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

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| 2026 | Roe L. Johns Travel Grant Award, Association for Education Finance & Policy |
| 2025-2026 | Ramsey & Utery Chair Funds, Georgia State University |
| 2024, 2025 | E.D. (Jack) Dunn Fellowship, Georgia State University |
| 2022-2026 | Second Century Initiative Doctoral Fellowship, Georgia State University |
| 2020 | Merit-Based Scholarship, University of Texas at Austin |
| 2019 | Li-Sing Tsai Scholarship (exchange program), National Central University, Taiwan |
| 2016-2019 | Academic Presidential Award (~top 5%), National Central University, Taiwan |

SKILLS

Coding Languages: Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, Markdown, SPSS

Languages: English (fluent), Chinese (native)

REFEREEING

The European Journal of Health Economics

REFERENCES

Prof. Lauren Hoehn-Velasco

Assistant Professor
Department of Economics
Georgia State University
lvelasco@gsu.edu

Prof. James Marton

Chair and Professor
Department of Economics
Georgia State University
marton@gsu.edu

Prof. Elaine M. Liu

Ramsey Chair and Professor
Department of Economics
Georgia State University
eliu@gsu.edu

Prof. Melanie Guidi

Associate Professor
Department of Economics
University of Central Florida
mguldi@ucf.edu

PAPER ABSTRACT

Bytes and Births: The Effect of Broadband Internet on Infant Health

I ask whether lowering the cost of information changes the health of the next generation, using the staggered rollout of the internet in the United States in the early 2000s and linking residential broadband diffusion to birth certificates. I find that broadband availability increases average birth weight. This gain reflects a reduction in the incidence of low birth weight (2,500g) and an increase in the incidence of high birth weight (4,000g). The estimated effects are comparable in magnitude to those of major U.S. safety-net programs, and the heterogeneous effects show that the impacts are broad-based. Additionally, broadband reduces the total birth rate and alters the composition of births, yet infant health improves even as births shift toward higher-risk groups. Overall, the paper highlights the information technology's meaningful role in early-life human capital formation.

The Long Shadow of Typhoons: Prenatal Exposure and Adult Mental Health

This paper examines how poor in utero conditions caused by severe typhoons affect psychological well-being later in life. We exploit variation in the timing and location of severe typhoon landfalls. Our design compares individuals with higher expected fetal exposure in landfall counties to those with no such exposure. A one-unit increase in expected in utero exposure raises the likelihood of an adult mental illness diagnosis by 2.2 percentage points, or 11 percent relative to the mean. The incidence of mood disorders such as depression and the use of antidepressants have risen by more than 50 percent. The adverse effects are concentrated among women. In a fully interacted model, we reject equality of the male and female effects for our main outcomes. This gender gap is not driven by differential healthcare-seeking behavior. We discuss several non-mutually exclusive mechanisms that could generate a genuinely female-concentrated effect, including sex-specific fetal programming and mortality selection.

Public Payment Mandates and Provider Supply: Evidence from Certified Nurse-Midwives

Public insurance reimbursement policies shape the structure and reach of healthcare markets. In this study, we examine the 1980 federal Medicaid mandate requiring states to reimburse Certified Nurse-Midwives (CNMs), one of the first federal reforms targeting non-physician providers. We find the mandate increased midwife-attended deliveries by 1.1 percentage points in states that adopted the mandate before 1988. This 1.1 percentage point increase reflects a 69% rise in midwife deliveries, adding almost 1,300 midwife births annually per state by 1988. At least 45 percent of this increase in midwife deliveries reflects a true expansion in midwife care rather than reporting changes. We also document a geographic expansion of midwife services into unserved areas and increased CNM employment. Our findings demonstrate that reimbursement mandates alter healthcare delivery by expanding provider supply and reshaping the workforce.

Full Day Kindergarten Mandates and Child Maltreatment

This study examines the effect of state-mandated full-day kindergarten (FDK) expansion on child maltreatment using National Data Archive on Child Abuse and Neglect (NCANDS) child-level data, State Inpatient Databases (SID) hospital discharge data, and National Vital Statistics System (NVSS) mortality records. Leveraging the staggered rollout of FDK adoption across states with advanced difference-in-differences methods, we find that FDK policies lead to an increase of 3.5 physical abuse reports per 1,000 children, approximately 36% relative to the baseline mean. The absence of an effect on the share of substantiated physical abuse and fatalities suggests that FDK primarily improves the detection of maltreatment rather than increasing its underlying incidence. Supporting this interpretation, educator-filed physical abuse reports rise by approximately 30%, reflecting enhanced detection capacity among teachers and school staff, and potentially replacing reports from other professions. Overall, this research provides new evidence on the broader benefits of early childhood education, particularly its role in strengthening child safety environments.